


Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

# The Beetle Who Knew the Stars

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: asking and listening.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

# For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

### The big idea

Asking makes room for other people's words, and it takes you farther than telling.

### Say it together

**Roll, roll, look up!**

## Five words from the story

| Word | What it means | Do it |
|---|---|---|
| **ask** | to say a question so you can find out | lift one hand, palm up |
| **dune** | a big hill of sand | draw a wave in the air |
| **crest** | the feathers on top of a bird's head | spread your fingers on top of your head |
| **shortcut** | a quicker way to get somewhere | zip your finger in a straight line |
| **guide** | to show someone the way | point ahead and walk two fingers |

### A gentle note

Knowing things is good. Keep the message that asking first is better, not that knowing is bad.

Children who are shy may find asking hard. Let them ask a puppet or write a question first.

### What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).


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# Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



## Kemi

Eurasian hoopoe

Knows lots of things and learns to ask first



## Sabu

Sacred scarab (dung beetle)

The quiet friend who looks up at the sky



## The kingfisher

Pied kingfisher

The chatty fisher on the papyrus stem



## The two frogs

Nile grass frogs

The cheerful croakers on the mud bank



## The jerboa family

Lesser Egyptian jerboa

The desert bouncers who know the way


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# How did they feel?

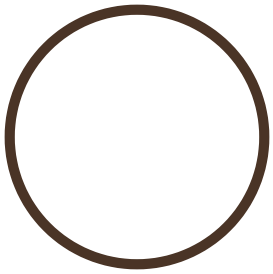
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

**Kemi tells everyone how to do things; her friends go quiet.**

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

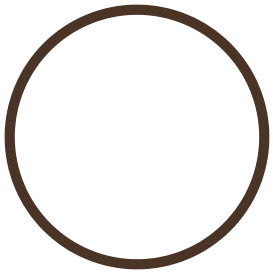


Moment 2

**Sabu's eyes sparkle: nobody had ever asked him.**

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

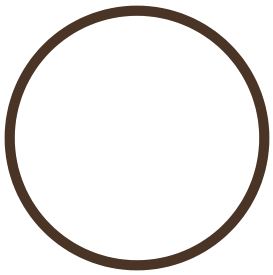


Moment 3

**Stars above, the Nile below.**

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

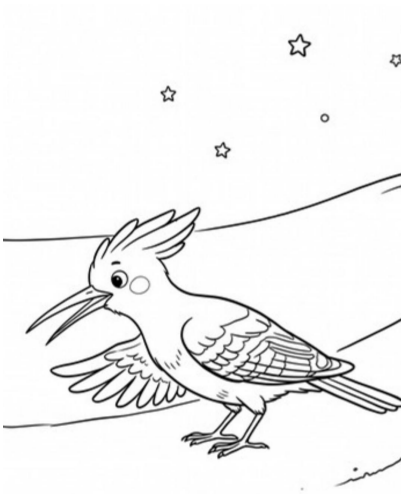
sad scared worried happy brave proud calm




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# Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

## Tell it in your own words

**First,** _____

**Then,** _____

**At the end,** _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.


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# Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

**ask** to say a question so you can find out

ask ask

**dune** a big hill of sand

dune dune

**crest** the feathers on top of a bird's head

crest crest

**Kemi** the hero of the story

Kemi Kemi

**Write your name**


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# Draw your own story

Kemi showed asking and listening. Draw a time when you showed asking and listening too, or a time you could.



**Tell a grown-up:** What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?


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# Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

### Ask first circle

You need: None

Partners take turns asking each other one question (‘What do you like to play?’) and listening to the whole answer before talking. Then each child tells the class one new thing they learned about their partner.

### Ask, don't tell

Play with a grown-up: for five minutes, you can only ask questions. What did you learn about them?

### Roll like Sabu

Roll a ball backwards with your feet in a straight line. Is it harder than it looks?

### Find the river of stars

On a dark, clear night away from city lights, look for a pale, cloudy band across the sky. That's the Milky Way.

### Draw what you made


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# The real animals

The animals in The Beetle Who Knew the Stars are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



## Kemi

Eurasian hoopoe

From about six days old, hoopoe chicks have a trick: they turn around and squirt their poop at anything that pokes into the nest, while hissing like a snake!



## Sabu

Sacred scarab (dung beetle)

In 2013 scientists showed that dung beetles can keep a straight path using the glowing band of the Milky Way. It was the first animal ever shown to use the Milky Way to find its way!



## The kingfisher

Pied kingfisher

Young birds, often sons of the father, help raise the new chicks by bringing food. Most pied kingfishers are males!



## The two frogs

Nile grass frogs

Egypt is mostly desert, but the Nile works like a green road that lets frogs from tropical Africa live far to the north.

## Story or real?

A real hoopoe's crest really does pop up when it is excited. But a real hoopoe eats insects, so in real life Sabu might want to keep his distance! And real hoopoes don't say "I know!" (as far as we know).

## Where they really live

The story doesn't name a town, so we picked a real place where everything in it happens side by side: Aswan in southern Egypt, where green palm islands sit in the Nile and golden dunes come right down to the river.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-beetle-who-knew-the-stars


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# Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?




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# Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

**What is the beetle doing? Why might a beetle know about the stars?**

The Beetle Who Knew the Stars, talk card 1

**Why did Kemi's friends stop talking when she came near?**

The Beetle Who Knew the Stars, talk card 2

**How did Kemi feel when she didn't know the way?**

The Beetle Who Knew the Stars, talk card 3

**What happened when she asked Sabu a question?**

The Beetle Who Knew the Stars, talk card 4

**Who knew the shortcut? How did they feel being asked?**

The Beetle Who Knew the Stars, talk card 5

**What question could you ask a friend today?**

The Beetle Who Knew the Stars, talk card 6


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# Asking and listening hero

This is to say that

_____

showed asking and listening, just like Kemi.

**Roll, roll, look up!**

Signed _____ Date _____


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